

how mere involvement of users (not developers or testers, just users) helped Linux grow at a tremendous speed. Along the way many bugs were found and fixed because of this involvement giving us the highly stable Linux we know today. The open source ideology has influenced every little aspect of our lives. We have so many free tools to complete

our daily tasks that we tick off a large part of our daily “to do” lists automatically without us noticing it.

OSI Affiliates, July 18, 2002



The Open Source movement gave us some of the best software around

The riders of the Linux wave come from all backgrounds, most often related to the web. Web development and infrastructures that power the web are usually backed by open source software. Also among users were school labs and universities, who had begun to realise that Microsoft was not

the only way to make a computer come to life. Its adoption has made Linux what it is today.

So what is Linux today, anyway?

Fast Forward to present day: Installation

While Linux purists might dislike Ubuntu for reasons ranging from “Unity is a bad UI” to “developers don’t listen to the community”, the fact remains that Ubuntu has turned out to be a leading distribution. Built on the foundation of Debian’s architecture and an awesome package management system, it delivers timely updates (as opposed to Debian, which focuses on stability) and has a very user-friendly installer. If you happen to stick to the default options on Ubuntu’s installer, on most occasions, it works quite well and ensures that your other operating systems are unaffected by its installation. This means that you can rest assured that a Linux installation won’t prevent access to the rest of your data.

If you compared it to the Linux from a decade ago, you’d recall that mounting a NTFS partition was a pain, more so when you wanted to write data on to a NTFS partition. Now, NTFS volumes are automatically detected and mounted for you.